DEFINITION *Model binding* extracts values from a request and uses them to create .NET objects. These objects are passed as method parameters to the endpoint handler being executed.

The model binder is responsible for looking through the request that comes in and finding values to use. Then it creates objects of the appropriate type and assigns these values to your model in a process called *binding.*

NOTE Model binding in minimal APIs (and in Razor Pages and Model-View-Controller [MVC]) is a one-way population of objects from the request, not the two-way data binding that desktop or mobile development sometimes uses.

ASP.NET Core automatically creates the arguments that are passed to your handler by using the request's properties, such as the request URL, any headers sent in the HTTP request, any data explicitly `POST`ed in the request body, and so on.

Model binding happens before the filter pipeline and your endpoint handler execute, in the `EndpointMiddleware`, as shown in figure 7.1. The `RoutingMiddleware` is responsible for matching an incoming request to an endpoint and for extracting the route parameter values, but all the values at that point are `string`s. It's only in the `EndpointMiddleware` that the `string` values are converted to the real argument types (such as `int`) needed to execute the endpoint handler.